

the file or the source of the file, which is stored at the FDM site and offered to other users going to download the same file. This can reduce unwanted downloads.

FDM also includes an FTP explorer, which allows browsing through FTP sites, and also a Web site extractor that can download an entire site for offline browsing. It can integrate with all browsers.

5.2.2 Gigaget (www.gigaget.com/download.htm)

This download manager promises to use “Net Grid” technology to speed up downloads. At the FAQ on the site, “Net Grid” is explained thus: “Gigaget applies the most advanced multi-resources and hyper-threading technology; it can tap the unused resources of networked PCs and servers, and improves your download speed by 7-10 times.” While it is hard to comprehend the explanation, Gigaget does manage to find mirror sites faster than other download managers.

Another promise is the use of “Intelligent Disk Cache system which protects your hard disk from high-speed download.” Which means that the hard disk is not written to until the disk cache gets full. While this could reduce the hard disk head movement, thus improving life, an improper shutdown would leave the cached data orphaned, leading to data corruption.

Gigaget is ad-supported, and doesn’t integrate with Opera, but the clipboard is monitored.

5.2.3 FlashGet (www.flashget.com/en/download.htm)

FlashGet (FG) includes a BitTorrent client. It doesn’t integrate with Firefox or Opera out of the box, but the required plugins can be downloaded from the site: www.flashget.com/en/addons.htm.

FG uses automatic bandwidth allocation, unlike other download managers. To clarify, other download managers can be set to utilise a part of the total bandwidth so that concurrent online activities like browsing are not adversely affected. Once a limit has